

Star-nosed mole



With its hyper-sensitive nose and lightning fast reflexes, this unique North American mole is a highly successful hunter of small invertebrates such as worms, insects, and spiders. It spends most of its life in its intricate system of burrows, where it rests, builds nests for rearing young, stores food, and traps prey.

NORTH AMERICA

Wet habitats

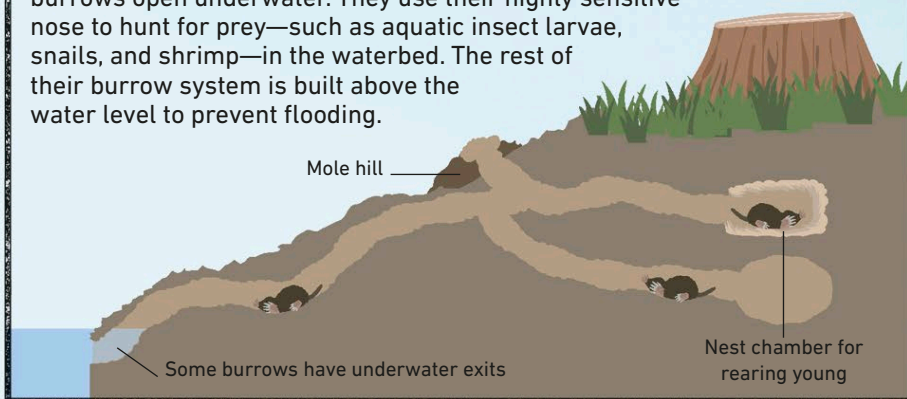
The star-nosed mole lives in a range of habitats across eastern North America, including coniferous and deciduous forests, swamps, peat bogs, and along the banks of streams, lakes, and ponds. It prefers to build its burrows in water-logged ground, and relies on its sense of smell to detect prey underground.

KEY

Star-nosed mole range

Semi-aquatic mammals

Star-nosed moles are excellent swimmers, and many of their burrows open underwater. They use their highly sensitive nose to hunt for prey—such as aquatic insect larvae, snails, and shrimp—in the waterbed. The rest of their burrow system is built above the water level to prevent flooding.



Western barrier

The star-nosed mole relies on wet habitats to feed and survive, so the western border of its range ends where the drier central prairies of North America begin.

Lake Superior

Mole hill

Most of its life is spent in underground burrows, but occasionally the star-nosed mole heads to the surface through mole hills in order to hunt prey at night.

THERE ARE **25,000 TOUCH SENSORS** ON THE **TENTACLES** OF A STAR-NOSED MOLE



STAR-NOSED MOLES EAT **50% OF THEIR BODY WEIGHT** IN PREY ANIMALS **EACH DAY**